

Bazaar



We test the latest and the best hardware and software products available in the market

Intel Pentium 4 3.2 GHz

The Last of the Northwood

The Pentium 4 3.2 GHz runs on a 200 MHz quad-pumped FSB, giving it a total bandwidth of 800 MHz. It supports Hyper-Threading Technology (HTT), which gives it a significant performance boost, and has a really easy-to-install cooling fan. We tested this processor on an Intel D875PBZ motherboard with support for 800 MHz FSB, 512 MB of DDR 333 MHz Kingmax RAM in dual channel mode, with an MSI Geforce4 Ti 4800 SE graphics accelerator.

In the *Quake III Arena* test, the 3.2 GHz was able to pump 387 fps at normal mode, 377 fps at high quality mode and 292 fps at a resolution of 1,024 x 768 and 32-bit colour depth. These figures may seem a bit low, but the bottleneck was the DDR 333 MHz RAM and the Ti 4800 SE graphics card.

On the 3DMark 2003 benchmark, the 3.2 GHz returned 700 CPU marks—the highest we have ever come across. In the Sisoft Sandra 2003 Pro's CPU arithmetic tests, it gave 9,649 Dhrystones and 6,059 Whetstones, and yielded similar results with CPU multimedia tests. The Integer benchmarks saw a

score of 14,693 and FPU SSE2 saw a huge 23,321. All these scores prove that the 3.2 GHz has an appetite for numbers.

In the memory bandwidth test, the dual channel displayed its advantage, scoring in the range of 4,000 and above. The new Intel silicon square was able to complete the video encoding process in just 70 seconds. However, in the PovRay 3.5 test, the CPU seemed to be lost, taking 29 seconds to complete the rendering. Overall, the new CPU set new records at times, and just failed to break existing records at others.

At a price tag of Rs 38,000, you could choose to ignore the 200 MHz increase and wait for something better—especially with the expected 64-bit Intel vs AMD war that is round the corner. But, for those of you who need the fastest CPU currently available, this is one of the best around—providing you can afford it.

SPECIFICATIONS

Pentium 4 3.2 GHz, 512 KB L2 cache, Northwood core, 800 MHz FSB support

Intel Pentium 4 3.2 GHz

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Performance	▶▶▶▶▶
Build quality	▶▶▶▶▶
Value for money	▶▶▶▶▶
Features	▶▶▶▶▶
OVERALL	▶▶▶▶▶

Price: Rs 38,000
Contact: Nebula Technologies
Phone: 022-26848612
Fax: 022-26848618
E-mail: pratik@nebulatechnologies.com
Web site: www.intel.com

Dell Latitude D600

Wireless anybody?

With the D600, Dell has gone in for a complete re-design of its Latitude series of laptops. The D600 measures 1.2 x 12.4 x 10.1 inches, weighs only 2.12 Kg, and is filled to the brim with features, such as the Strike Zone Technology that protects the hard disk from shock.

Its Centrino-based motherboard has the slower 802.11b (11 MBps) wireless LAN connectivity. Those concerned about the compatibility

issues of Centrino with existing 802.11g network equipment can opt for the Dell TrueMobile Wireless LAN Solutions that gives an additional 802.11 b/g or 802.11 a/b/g mini-PCI card. It has dual band capabilities which enable it to hop on to both 2.4 GHz as well as 5 GHz frequencies.

The standard POVRay benchmark, which takes about 45 minutes on a Pentium 4, 2 GHz, took just 58 minutes and 47 seconds on the D600, proving its processing power.

The operating temperature shot up to 57 degrees after about 5 hours of use—

very uncomfortable if you have it on your lap.

The keyboard is comfortable, and you can use the touchpad with a pair of mouse buttons below it, or the pointing stick with a different pair of buttons.

It has a diagnostic utility that can be used to recover your system after a crash. The diagnostic utility correctly diagnosed the problems that occurred after a system crash.

The laptop comes with a three year onsite warranty. Overall, it is a sleek, high performance mobile device that is perfect for executives on the move.

SPECIFICATIONS

Intel Pentium M 1.40 GHz, Windows XP Professional SP1, 512 MB DDR RAM (up to 2 GB supported), Removable 20, 30, 40, 60 GB hard drive, Combination DVD and CD-RW drive (8X24X10X24X), ATI Mobility Radeon 9000 graphics chipset, Intel PRO Wireless 2100 WLAN (802.11b) mini-PCI card, Integrated 56 K V.92 modem and 10/100/1000 MBps Ethernet LAN

Dell Latitude D600

A

Performance	▶▶▶▶▶
Build Quality	▶▶▶▶▶
Value for money	▶▶▶▶▶
Features	▶▶▶▶▶
OVERALL	▶▶▶▶▶

Price: Rs 1,53,366
Contact: Dell Computers Asia
Phone: 1600-33-8044 (toll free)
Fax: 080-5586107
E-mail: marketing_response@dell.com
Web site: www.dell.com